Window: setImmediate() method

Deprecated

Non-standard: This feature is not standardized. We do not recommend using non-standard features in production, as they have limited browser support, and may change or be removed. However, they can be a suitable alternative in specific cases where no standard option exists.

This method is used to break up long-running operations and run a callback function immediately after the browser has completed other operations such as events and display updates.

Syntax

JS

```
setImmediate(func)
setImmediate(func, param1)
setImmediate(func, param1, param2)
setImmediate(func, param1, param2, /* …, */ paramN)
```

Parameters

`func`

The function you wish to call.

`param1`, ..., `paramN`

All parameters will be passed directly to your function.

Return value

The ID of the immediate which can be used later with `window.clearImmediate`.

Notes

The `clearImmediate()` method can be used to clear the immediate actions, just like `clearTimeout()` for `setTimeout()`.

This method can be used instead of the `setTimeout(fn, 0)` method to execute heavy operations.

The feature can be emulated in a few different ways:

- `postMessage()` can be used to trigger an immediate but yielding callback.
- `MessageChannel` can be used reliably inside of Web Workers whereas the semantics of postMessage mean it cannot be used there.
- `setTimeout(fn, 0)` *can* potentially be used, however as it is clamped to 4ms for timers nested more than 5 levels deep per the HTML spec, it does not make for a suitable polyfill for the natural immediacy of `setImmediate`.

All of these techniques are incorporated into a robust setImmediate polyfill.

Specifications

Not part of any current specifications. The Efficient Script Yielding specification is no longer being worked on.

Browser compatibility

Report problems with this compatibility data • View data on GitHub

Settings

	Chrome	Edge	Firefox	Opera	Safari	Chrome Android	Firefox for Android	Opera Android	Safari on iOS	Samsung Browser	WebView Android	WebView on iOS	Deno	Node.js
`setImmediate`	No	12–18	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	2.1	0.10

Full support · Partial support · No support · Non-standard. Check cross-browser support before using.

Deprecated. Not for use in new websites. · User must explicitly enable this feature.

See also

- Polyfill of `setImmediate` in `core-js`
- Microsoft `setImmediate` API Demo
- `Window.clearImmediate()`
- `Window.requestIdleCallback()`

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